

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Psychology • Current affairs • Languages • Mathematics • Science • Information Technology (IT) • History • Economics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Intelligence officers usually have a degree, or higher, qualification in a subject related to their specialization, such as forensics.



LIFESTYLE Intelligence officers typically work regular office hours, but overtime is often required during investigations.



LOCATION Most intelligence officers are mainly office-based, but may need to travel to the scene of a crime or to a location that is under surveillance.



THE REALITIES Intelligence work can be intensive and must be kept secret. During selection, candidates are subject to intrusive vetting procedures.

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent written and verbal skills for writing and presenting intelligence reports.



The ability to work with fellow colleagues and specialists from other agencies.



Excellent observational, analytical, and research skills, and an aptitude for creative problem-solving.



Proficiency in computer software for identifying significant data, and analyzing and recording it.



An organized approach to tasks, which may last many years, and the ability to prioritize.



HUMAN OPERATIONS OFFICER

Gathers intelligence by making contact with sources, ranging from covert conversations with unsuspecting targets to the interrogation of suspects. Also plans and executes cover missions and briefs government officials.



IMAGERY INTELLIGENCE OFFICER

Collects vital information via satellite and aerial photography. The information received will form the basis of many military operations.



SIGNALS INTELLIGENCE OFFICER

Specializes in gathering intelligence by analyzing intercepted communications, both personal (such as telephone calls) and electronic (such as encrypted emails).

The United States' intelligence agency, the CIA, monitors five million tweets every day.